

Mouloud Mammeri University

Department of Computer Science

Module: Foreign Language 1

Session 2: Technical Vocabulary and Past Simple Tense

1. Computer Vocabulary

1.1 Hardware

Physical components of a computer that we can touch. Examples: **computer**, **keyboard**, **mouse**, **monitor**, **printer**. The **CPU** is the “brain” of the computer.

1.2 Software

Programs and instructions that tell the computer what to do. Examples: **Operating System**, **Applications**, **Antivirus**.

1.3 Internet and Networking

A **network** is a group of computers and devices connected together to share information and resources. Networks can be small, like at home or in a university, or very large — the biggest one is the Internet.

The Internet is a global network that connects computers, people, and devices around the world. It allows us to communicate, send emails, exchange data, and visit websites anytime, anywhere.

When we download, we receive data. When we upload, we send data.

Every website has a URL (Uniform Resource Locator), which is its web address. Email means electronic mail, and it needs a username, a password, and an email server for security.

1.4 Modern Concepts

Artificial Intelligence (AI): allows computers to learn and make decisions, like humans.

Cloud Computing: means using online storage instead of your computer.

Data: means information — text, images, videos, or numbers.

Data is very important because it helps companies make smart decisions.

An Algorithm: is a series of logical steps to solve a problem.

2. Computer Vocabulary in English and French

- Computer – Ordinateur
- Keyboard – Clavier
- Monitor / Screen – Écran
- Mouse – Souris
- Printer – Imprimante
- Scanner – Scanner
- Software – Logiciel
- Hardware – Matériel
- File – Fichier
- Folder – Dossier
- Internet – Internet
- Email – Courriel
- Password – Mot de passe
- Download – Télécharger
- Upload – Téléverser
- Website – Site web
- Browser – Navigateur
- Application / App – Application
- Network – Réseau
- Wi-Fi – Wi-Fi
- Cloud – Nuage
- Storage – Stockage
- Database – Base de données
- Processor / CPU – Processeur
- Hard Drive – Disque dur
- USB – USB
- Operating System – Système d'exploitation
- Algorithm – Algorithme
- Coding / Programming – Programmation
- Backup – Sauvegarde
- Artificial Intelligence (AI) – Intelligence artificielle
- Data – Données
- Big Data – Big Data
- Machine Learning – Apprentissage automatique
- Deep Learning – Apprentissage profond
- Neural Network – Réseau neuronal
- Cloud Computing – Informatique en nuage
- Simulation – Simulation
- Virtual Reality (VR) – Réalité virtuelle
- Augmented Reality (AR) – Réalité augmentée
- Database Management System (DBMS) – Système de gestion de bases de données
- Compiler – Compilateur
- Debugger – Débogueur

- Data Mining – Exploration de données
 - Encryption – Chiffrement
 - Programming Language – Langage de programmation
 - Data Analysis – Analyse des données
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3. Past Simple Tense

Used for actions completed at a specific time in the past.

Structure:

Affirmative: Subject + verb + **ed**

Negative: Subject + **did not** + base form of verb

Question: **Did** + subject + base form of verb

Examples:

- The scientist recorded the temperature every hour.
- The student completed the homework before the deadline.
- Did the artist finish painting the mural yesterday?
- The chef prepared the meal with fresh ingredients.
- The team did not win the championship last year.
- Did the doctor explain the treatment plan clearly?
- The teacher did not check the assignments carefully.

Regular Verbs

Regular verbs follow a predictable pattern when forming the past tense and past participle.

Rule: Add **-ed** or **-d** to the base form.

Examples:

- walk → walked → walked
- love → loved → loved

Irregular Verbs

Irregular verbs do not follow a predictable pattern and often change the vowel, consonant, or both.

Rule: These verbs must be memorized as there is no consistent pattern.

Examples:

- go → went → gone
- sing → sang → sung
- cut → cut → cut

Summary

Regular verbs: Consistent pattern — add **-ed**.

Irregular verbs: No consistent pattern — must be memorized.

Uses of the Past Simple

- To describe completed actions in the past.
Example: Alan Turing designed the Enigma machine.
- To describe past achievements or discoveries.
Example: Ada Lovelace created the first algorithm for a computing machine.
- To describe repeated actions or habits in the past.
Example: They used log tables to solve problems before calculators were invented.

Time Markers

Common time expressions:

Yesterday, Last week/month/year, In [specific year], A long time ago

Examples:

- Last year, the students developed a software program.
- In 1928, John von Neumann introduced the concept of the stored-program computer.

4. Comparative Form

Definition: The comparative form is used to compare two people, objects, or ideas by highlighting their differences in degree, quantity, or quality.

Structure of the Comparative Form

- **Short Adjectives (1 syllable):** Add **-er + than**.
Example: fast → faster than.
This computer is faster than the old one.
- **Long Adjectives (2+ syllables):** Use **more + adjective + than**.
Example: efficient → more efficient than.
The new algorithm is more efficient than the previous one.
- **Irregular Adjectives:**
Good → better than
Bad → worse than
Far → farther than

Uses of the Comparative Form

A. In Mathematics

- To compare numbers, equations, or results.
Examples: 10 is greater than 5.
The new formula is more accurate than the old one.

B. In Computer Science

- To compare systems, technologies, or processes.
Examples: Python is easier than Java for beginners.
The latest processor is faster than the previous generation.

5. Cardinal and Ordinal Numbers

1. Cardinal Numbers

Definition: Represent quantity or "how many."

Examples: 1, 2, 3, 4, 10, 100.

Usage: Counting objects or expressing amounts.

Example: There are 20 students in the classroom.

2. Ordinal Numbers

Definition: Represent position or order in a sequence.

Examples: 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th, 10th, 100th.

Usage: Indicating order.

Example: This is my third attempt.

3. Decimal Numbers

Definition: Consist of two parts: a whole number and a fractional part (after the decimal point).

Example: In $12.5 \rightarrow 12$ is the whole part, 0.5 is the fractional part ($5/10$).

4. Names of Big Numbers

$1,000,000 = \text{Million}$

$1,000,000,000 = \text{Billion}$

$1,000,000,000,000 = \text{Trillion}$

$100,000,000,000,000 = \text{Quadrillion}$